

SEDIMENTARY ROCKS

Sedimentary rocks are generally characterized by stratification, or bedding, and they can contain fossils. These rocks are divided into three groups according to their origin. Clastic rocks are made up of fragments of rocks and minerals eroded from previously formed rocks; organic rocks are derived from the remains of plants and animals; chemical rocks result from the precipitation of chemicals.



MICACEOUS SANDSTONE

Rich in quartz, this sandstone also contains glittery flakes of mica. It usually has medium-sized grains.



ROCK SALT

Composed of halite, rock salt is often coloured by inclusions of iron oxides and clay minerals. It is soluble in water, with a low hardness and a salty taste.



BOULDER CLAY

Grey to brownish in colour, boulder clay, or till, has a very fine-grained clay matrix with glacially derived angular and rounded rock fragments.



BANDED IRONSTONE

This rock, deposited in marine or fresh water, has alternating bands of black hematite and red chert. It is one of the best ores of iron.



MILLET-SEED SANDSTONE

The medium-sized grains of this rock are often coated with reddish iron oxides. The well-rounded, equal-sized quartz grains have been shaped by the wind.



LIMONITIC SANDSTONE

This rock is coloured red-brown or yellowish by the iron oxide mineral limonite, which coats its medium quartz grains.



ROCK GYPSUM

A crystalline rock formed when salt water evaporates, rock gypsum is pale coloured, often fibrous, and very soft. It occurs with other evaporite minerals.



CLAYSTONE

Of varying colour, this very fine-grained rock is composed mainly of silicate clay minerals such as kaolinite – mostly derived from the weathering of feldspars.



GREENSAND

Coloured greenish by the silicate mineral glauconite, greensand is a quartz-rich sandstone formed in the sea.



SANDSTONE

SANDSTONE

This rock typically occurs as layers of sand grains, held together by various mineral cements that impart different colours. Sandstones are quartz-rich.



RED SANDSTONE

quartz grains coloured by iron oxides

bands of hematite and chert



LOESS

A clay with very fine, dust-like grains lifted by the wind from dry land surfaces, loess is crumbly and lacks obvious layering.



OOLITIC IRONSTONE

This rock is composed of small, rounded grains (ooliths) of iron minerals, such as siderite, cemented by other iron minerals, as well as by calcite and quartz.



TRAVERTINE

A pale-coloured and often layered rock, travertine is virtually pure calcite. It is formed around hot springs and volcanic vents.